

Miners Baseball Team Opens Season Saturday

The outlook for the 1972 baseball season at U.T.-El Paso hinges upon the pitching.

And it won't take long for Coach Andy Cohen to make an appraisal, as his Miners inaugurate the season Saturday when they host Ranger, Tex. Junior College in a 1 p.m. doubleheader at Dudley Field.

"We have a lot of strong arms, but need to gain experience," said Cohen. "As the pitching goes, so will go our team."

Gone is ace southpaw Marc Bombard, who finished third in final NCAA statistics in seasonal victories — 13, also a school record. Marc led the club in most departments, excluding most walks issued, and had 109 innings pitched and won all six of U.T.-El Paso's Western Athletic Conference victories in '71.

Cohen has only two experienced pitchers — Phil Darwin and Ernie Carreon. However, things aren't as bad in other areas. Cohen is extremely pleased with the depth, saying "it's the best in many years."

Miner prospects, by position:

PITCHING: Questionmark. Cohen has but two lettermen returning. Righthander Phil Darwin posted a 1-4 record a year ago while senior Ernie Carreon had a 1-1 record.

Several youngsters showed promise during preseason workouts. Service veteran Tony Eaton, a lefty, figures to be a starter. Southpaw Terry Williams, a freshman from Florida, has a sore shoulder, but is slated to see a lot of action when well. Frank Del Toro and Joel Kunstler have looked good.

The biggest transition is moving Tim Peden, first string catcher last season, to the mound. Peden has a strong right arm and good size (6-3, 210) and showed good progress in preseason drills. Others vying for spots include Richard Taeger, Mike Beltran, Ray Greggerson, Bob Knox and Gilbert Rodriguez.

INFIELD: Good. Andy is pleased with the speed and agility of the candidates, which is much improved over a year ago. The biggest battle for a starting job is being waged at third base between Jan Hood and Max Swafford. Both are good fielders, but Hood perhaps swings a stronger bat.

At shortstop letterman Ernie Hernandez is fighting to keep his job against Larry Hunnicutt and Bob Hess. Returning letterman Terry Baker seems to have a hold on second base although Chuck Garcia has looked good.

Junior letterman Barry Alburto will start at first base and is backed by Frank Del Toro and Joel Kuentler. Infield depth will be supplied by Eloy Alvarado and Bob Morales, both of whom can also play the outfield.

OUTFIELD: Inexperienced, but quicker. Gone are Bob Prokopowicz and Brian Harper. Prokopowicz was the ninth leading hitter in the nation last year with a .422 average, while Harper swung the bat at a .381 clip and was fourth in the nation with 19 doubles.

Cohen hopes his newly acquired speed will make up for the losses. Centerfield could become Malcolm McClean's property. He covers plenty of ground and showed in preseason he can swing the bat.

Joe Pennies could be a starter at any position and Lali Maldonado had a fine spring in left field. Other candidates are Joel Kuentler and Frank Del Toro, also slated for mound duty, and Joe Hernandez, former Austin High standout.

CATCHING: Weaker. "We're hurting somewhat because we are trying to convert Tim Peden into a pitcher," said Cohen. Peden had three years experience behind the plate, but his arm may be needed more on the mound.

Clint Newsome, two-year letterman, is heading the list for the catcher's spot. Also on hand are Ernie Hernandez and Eloy Alvarado.

Arizona 'Cats Snap Losing Skein, 53-51

TUCSON, Ariz. (AP) — Junior forward Tom Lawson sank a 30-foot jump shot with one second left to end a seven-game Arizona losing streak as the Wildcats defeated New Mexico 53-51 in a Western Athletic conference basketball game Thursday night.

New Mexico stole the ball with 1:06 left to play with the score tied 51-51. But the Lobos lost the ball with 20 seconds left on the clock on a back-count violation.

The Wildcats then held the ball to set up Lawson's final shot.

Arizona held a 29-24 lead at halftime, but New Mexico rallied, and the game was tied several times during the second half.

Jim Huckestein led the Wildcats with 15 points with Lawson adding 14. Mike Faulkner was top man for the Lobos with 19.

College Scores

Villanova 104, Seton Hall 62
New Hampshire 61, Mass. 36
Baptist 81, W. Car. 78
SW Missouri 87, S. Ill.-Edwardsville 82
Houston 105, Corpus Christi 81
Arizona 53, New Mexico 51
S. Dakota St. 78, Augustana, S.D. 71
South Dakota 84, Morningside 71
North Dakota 84, North Dakota St. 69
Northern Iowa 67, Mankato 62
Oral Roberts 135, Union, Tenn. 113
St. Louis 72, Fordham 71
Eastern New Mexico 75, College of Santa Fe 44
Okla. City U. 101, Tulsa 100, overtime
Rochester Tech 65, Fredonia St. 63
Nyack 87, W. Conn. 69
Houston Baptist 70, Louisiana Coll. 64
Randolph-Macon 102, Hampden-Sydney 62
Tex. Southern 99, Miss. Valley 86
Ark. Tech 79, Southern St. 74
Ark-Monticello 82, Ark. Coll. 67
Quacota 98, Ozarks 75
Harding 76, Henderson 72

Girl Cagers Set For Rematch

A girls basketball team representing New Mexico State will travel to El Paso to duel a similar team from U.T. El